AISG | AI SAFEGUARDING & GOVERNANCE For all school staff, supply staff and volunteers in England

The safeguarding never list

What staff must never do with images, devices and disclosures — and what to do instead.

Your job is the child in front of you, not the evidence.

Securing, viewing and deciding are for the designated safeguarding lead (DSL) and the police.

⚠ Urgent: act now, do not wait

Child in immediate danger

Call **999** — including an immediate risk of self-harm. Then tell the DSL.

Sextortion: threats to share images

Reach the DSL **straight away**, before the pupil goes home. Advise: do not pay, stop replying, delete nothing. Never ask to see the messages.

NEVER DO THIS

Never view, ask for, forward, save, screenshot, print or copy an image — real or AI-generated, not even "as evidence". Copying it can itself be a crime.	Law · UKCIS
Never look through a device a pupil hands you. Keep it secure for the DSL.	UKCIS
Never open, share or delete an image sent to your own device.	UKCIS
Never delete anything, or tell a pupil to. That is the DSL's decision.	UKCIS · NCA
Never investigate or interview. No leading questions; do not question others, confront anyone or contact parents yourself.	UKCIS
Never promise to keep it secret. Say who you will tell, and why.	KCSIE
Never blame or shame anyone — including a pupil who forwarded an image.	UKCIS · NCA
Never let an AI tool decide if a child is at risk, or delay a report.	AISG

DO THIS INSTEAD

Listen calmly and reassure: "You are not in trouble. This is not your fault."	UKCIS · NCA
Look away if shown an image — you do not need to see it to report it. If you saw it by accident, tell the DSL.	UKCIS
Tell the DSL or deputy immediately, in person or by phone — not by email alone.	KCSIE · UKCIS

Who to tell

The DSL or deputy, in person or by phone. Neither free? Do not wait: speak to a senior leader or children's social care.

What to record

Same day, on your school's system: their words; date, time, place; app, usernames; what you did, who you told. **Never** the image or guesses.

When to escalate

- **Adult involved or coercion:** the DSL tells the police.
- **About staff:** the headteacher, or chair of governors if it is the head.

Basis key. Law: Protection of Children Act 1978. **KCSIE**: Keeping children safe in education 2026 (DfE). **UKCIS**: Sharing nudes and semi-nudes (UKCIS, updated March 2024). **NCA**: sextortion alert (April 2024). **AISG**: our recommended practice.

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